

ROOMLINK

Department Manager Product Requirements Document

V1.0 - Pilot Release

Purpose

Enable a Department Manager to own and deliver guest-service work within their assigned department.

Role condition

This is an optional role. Hotels may operate a department directly through Reception and staff when no manager is assigned.

CONFIDENTIAL

Prepared for product design, engineering, pilots, and future implementation reference.

Document Control

Item	Detail
Product	RoomLink
Document	Department Manager Product Requirements Document
Version	V1.0 - Pilot Release
Classification	Confidential
Platform	Responsive web / PWA
Primary user	Optional Department Manager
Pilot scenario	110-room hotel uses managers; 15-room hotel validates operation with no managers

1. Objective

The Department Manager is the operational owner of guest-service work for one assigned department. They turn requests into completed service by coordinating their team and keeping Reception informed.

- Own the assigned department queue and promptly acknowledge work.
- Assign or reassign eligible staff, monitor progress and remove blockers.
- Communicate operational updates through internal notes and, where permitted, guest messages.
- Escalate exceptions to Reception or the Hotel Admin / GM.

A Department Manager is optional. If none exists, Reception and the Hotel Admin / GM coordinate work directly with eligible staff.

2. Scope, Permissions and Boundaries

Department Manager can	Department Manager cannot
See and act on requests assigned to their department(s).	See or manage requests in unrelated departments unless explicitly assigned a manager role there.
Assign/reassign eligible department staff; update status; add notes; escalate.	Create/deactivate hotel users; configure hotel, GST/legal data, rooms, QR codes, departments, or subscription.
View their departmental performance, activity and eligible staff.	Manage the Restaurant menu unless the product explicitly gives the manager that department-scoped capability.
Communicate with Reception and, where allowed, with the guest.	Access other hotels or RoomLink platform administration.

3. Department Dashboard

The first screen after login is a focused department work queue, not a hotel-wide management dashboard.

Area	Requirements
Queue KPIs	New, unassigned, assigned, in progress, completed today, delayed/escalated.
Live work list	Room, service, priority, status, assignee, elapsed time, latest note/update.
Team availability	Eligible staff list with active status and current workload, where available.
Alerts	New request, unassigned item, stalled work, escalation, guest response or staff issue.
Quick actions	Open task, assign/reassign, accept, update status, add note, message, escalate.

4. Department Queue and Task Detail

Managers see only the guest requests that route to their department. Request details include the room, service, guest-visible notes, active request status, priority, timestamps, assigned staff, conversation, and internal activity timeline.

- Filter by status, priority, room, assignee and date; sort by oldest, newest, priority and SLA risk.
- Use states: New -> Assigned -> In Progress -> Completed; support Cancelled and Escalated when appropriate.
- Record every material action in the timeline with actor and time.

5. Staff Assignment and Multi-Department Eligibility

The manager assigns only staff eligible for the department. One staff member may belong to several departments, so the same person may be selected for work in each department they belong to.

Situation	Manager action
New request	Acknowledge and assign an eligible staff member, or keep unassigned with a clear reason/alert.
Staff unavailable	Reassign, request Reception support, or escalate to the GM.
Multi-department employee	Assign when the employee belongs to this department; do not assume they are restricted to one team.
Skill requirement	V1 treats department membership as eligibility. Service-specific certification/skill matching is future scope.

6. Service Execution and Status Control

State	Manager responsibility
New	Review and acknowledge promptly; decide assignment path.
Assigned	Confirm accountability and monitor acceptance/progress.
In Progress	Monitor updates; support staff if a blocker emerges.
Completed	Confirm completion information is accurate; ensure the guest is informed through the defined workflow.
Cancelled	Use only where appropriate; record the reason and actor.
Escalated	State the reason, urgency and recipient; continue tracking to resolution.

7. Relationship with Reception and GM

Counterpart	Working relationship
Reception	Receives and monitors hotel-wide requests, may assign/reassign or escalate. The manager owns execution inside the department and keeps the request current.
Hotel Admin / GM	Configures departments, staff and services; has hotel-wide visibility and can intervene in every department.
Department Staff	Performs the work and updates progress. The manager coordinates, reallocates and resolves blockers.

Expected V1 handoff when a manager exists: Guest -> Reception -> Department Manager -> Staff -> Complete -> Guest.

8. Department-Specific Context

Department example	Manager operational focus
Housekeeping	Prioritize room cleaning, supplies and guest timing; allocate shifts/workload.
Maintenance	Triage AC, TV, Wi-Fi, plumbing and electricity; identify critical issues and escalate promptly.
Restaurant	Coordinate food-order preparation and availability; keep status accurate for Reception and guests.
Other/custom	Use the service routing and priority rules configured by the Hotel Admin / GM.

9. Communications and Notifications

Managers receive in-app and push notifications for new department requests, assignments, SLA risk, guest replies, reassignments and escalations. They can add internal notes to coordinate with staff and Reception. Guest messaging is available only where the hotel workflow grants it; Reception remains the hotel-wide guest-service coordination layer.

10. Navigation

Navigation	Purpose
Dashboard / Queue	Department work triage and immediate actions.
Requests	All department request history and filtering.
Team	Eligible staff, status and workload view.
Activity	Department operational activity.
Notifications	Alerts and role-permitted preferences.
Profile	Own account and sign-out.

11. UX Requirements

- Responsive PWA, usable on a phone or tablet while moving through hotel operations.
- Few-click execution: open task -> assign -> update -> complete/escalate.
- Highly visible priority, elapsed time, assignment and status cues.
- Loading, empty, error and success states on every page.
- Confirm cancellations and significant reassignments; capture reasons for auditable exceptions.

12. Audit and Activity

The department activity timeline records assignment, reassignment, status changes, messages, notes, escalations, cancellations and completion. Reception and the Hotel Admin / GM can inspect this operational history. Complete platform security audit records remain with Super Admin.

13. Acceptance Criteria

Area	Acceptance criteria
Department isolation	Manager sees only their assigned department(s) and eligible team.
Triage	Manager can find and prioritize current departmental work.
Assignment	Manager can assign/reassign only eligible staff, including multi-department employees.
Execution	Manager can track work through New, Assigned, In Progress, Completed, Cancelled and Escalated states.
Coordination	Manager can add internal notes, receive alerts and escalate to Reception/GM.
Boundaries	Manager cannot change hotel-wide setup, users, rooms/QR, GST/legal or platform controls.
Auditability	Every material task action is visible in the request timeline.

14. Pilot Acceptance Tests

Pilot	Required Department Manager test
Hotel A - 110 rooms	A Housekeeping, Restaurant or Maintenance Manager receives a routed request, assigns eligible staff, monitors progress, handles an exception, and completes it with full activity history.

Pilot	Required Department Manager test
Hotel B - 15 rooms	No Department Manager account is required. The same request workflow remains functional through Reception -> eligible staff, proving the role is optional.
Multi-department test	A manager can assign a qualifying cross-department employee such as Raju only when the employee belongs to the manager's department.

15. Non-Goals

- Hotel-wide configuration, user provisioning, rooms/QR setup, GST/legal records, subscription administration.
- PMS, reservation, full check-in/check-out, payroll, inventory, accounting and advanced workforce scheduling.
- Service-specific staff certifications, advanced skills matrix, AI chatbot, advanced CRM and loyalty.
- Restaurant POS functions beyond lightweight menu/order workflow where relevant.

16. Final V1 Principle

The Department Manager is an optional departmental execution layer. When present, they own the department queue and staff coordination; when absent, RoomLink still works through Reception and eligible staff.

The V1 experience must make departmental execution fast, accountable and visible without adding a separate product path for smaller hotels.